



47. What does the word “backfire” in Paragraph 1 most probably mean?
 A. Slow down progress. B. Bring about improvement.
 C. Make things worse. D. Keep things unchanged.
48. The writer probably agrees that _____.
 A. better sleep comes after high-intensity workouts
 B. having the right exercise routine improves sleep
 C. we can improve our sleep quickly by doing moderate exercises
 D. we should keep our morning exercise at a low intensity when possible
49. What is the writer’s main purpose in writing this passage?
 A. To talk about possible risks of wrong exercise timing.
 B. To introduce new research findings about sleep and exercise.
 C. To give suggestions on how to improve sleep through exercise.
 D. To show the differences between some common exercise routines.

D

Encouraging two languages at home can have many benefits, especially for kids with autism (自闭症), says new research led by Celia Romero from the University of Miami.

Researchers studied the role of bilingualism (使用两种语言) in 112 children, including children with autism and those without, from the ages of 7 to 12 years old. Overall, they found children who spoke two or more languages had stronger executive functioning (执行功能) skills. These children could control their actions better and switch between tasks more easily than children who spoke only one language. These improvements also help ease certain symptoms (症状) for children with autism.



Executive functioning skills are mental processes that help us plan, focus, remember orders, and finish tasks quickly. They are important for children to do well in school and later in the workplace, but they are challenging for children with autism. Through research, Romero’s team found bilingualism has benefits for all children.

The study looked at how speaking many languages influences autism symptoms like understanding others’ feelings and social communication. “We found that bilingual children can better understand someone else’s thoughts or point of view than children who speak only one language,” added researcher Romero.

An idea called “bilingual advantage (优势)” can help explain the results. For bilingual speakers, the daily experience of switching between languages might improve executive control. “If you use two languages, you must stop one to use the other. This stopping skill might get stronger when you know two languages,” said Professor Uddin.

Romero became interested in this when she noticed that some bilingual families did not teach their children two languages because they thought it may be too challenging and harmful. “We’ve learnt that bilingualism has benefits for children with or without autism, but often it takes time to translate that to families, so I hope this study helps,” said Romero.

Romero and her co-worker are now doing further research with preschool children to see if bilingualism also has an impact on kids’ interactions (互动) with their friends. Uddin is also doing a large follow-up study about the influence of bilingualism on brains in children with autism.

50. What did Romero’s team find in the study?
 A. Switching between tasks is harder for bilingual children.
 B. More families are teaching children two languages at home.
 C. Bilingualism benefits common children more than autistic children.
 D. Speaking two languages improves children’s executive functioning skills.
51. What can we learn from the passage?
 A. Bilingual children can better understand others’ thoughts.
 B. Bilingualism helps preschool kids to get along with others.
 C. It’s harmful to teach autistic children more than one language.
 D. Switching between languages causes problems for autistic children.